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Systems and methods for analyzing and labeling images in a retail facility

Abstract

In some embodiments, apparatuses and methods are provided herein useful to processing captured images. In some embodiments, there is provided a system for processing captured images of objects including a memory and a control circuit executing a trained machine learning model. The memory may be configured to store a plurality of images comprising first images and second images. The control circuit may be configured to: allocate each of the first images into one of a plurality of datasets; cluster each image in the dataset into one of a plurality of groups; select a sample from at least one of the plurality of groups; cluster each of the second images into one of dominant product identifier group and a non-dominant product identifier group; select a sample from the dominant product identifier group and a sample from the non-dominant product identifier group; and output the selected sample.

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Background/Summary

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) This invention relates generally to recognition of objects in images, and more specifically to training machine learning models to recognize objects in images.

BACKGROUND

(2) A typical product storage facility (e.g., a retail store, a product distribution center, a warehouse, etc.) may have hundreds of shelves and thousands of products stored on the shelves or on pallets. It is common for workers of such product storage facilities to manually (e.g., visually) inspect or inventory product display shelves and/or pallet storage areas to determine which of the products are adequately stocked and which products are or will soon be out of stock and need to be replenished.

(3) Given the very large number of product storage areas such as shelves, pallets, and other product displays at product storage facilities of large retailers, and the even larger number of products stored in the product storage areas, manual inspection of the products on the shelves/pallets by the workers is very time consuming and significantly increases the operations cost for a retailer, since these workers could be performing other tasks if they were not involved in manually inspecting the product storage areas.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) Disclosed herein are embodiments of systems, apparatuses and methods pertaining to processing captured images of objects at a product storage facility. This description includes drawings, wherein:

(2) FIG. 1 is a diagram of an exemplary system of updating inventory of products at a product storage facility in accordance with some embodiments, depicting a front view of a product storage area storing groups of various individual products for sale and stored at a product storage facility;

(3) FIG. 2 comprises a block diagram of an exemplary image capture device in accordance with some embodiments;

(4) FIG. 3 is a functional block diagram of an exemplary computing device in accordance with some embodiments;

(5) FIG. 4 illustrates a simplified block diagram of an exemplary system for processing captured images of objects at a product storage facility in accordance with some embodiments;

(6) FIG. 5 illustrates an exemplary system for processing captured images of objects at a product storage facility in accordance with some embodiments;

(7) FIG. 6 shows a flow diagram of an exemplary method of processing captured images of objects at a product storage facility in accordance with some embodiments;

(8) FIG. 7 illustrates an exemplary system for processing captured images of objects at a product storage facility in accordance with some embodiments;

(9) FIG. 8 shows a flow diagram of an exemplary method of processing captured images of objects at a product storage facility in accordance with some embodiments;

(10) FIG. 9 shows a flow diagram of an exemplary method of processing captured images of objects at a product storage facility in accordance with some embodiments; and

(11) FIG. 10 illustrates an exemplary system for use in implementing methods, techniques, devices,

apparatuses, systems, servers, sources and processing captured images of objects at a product storage facility in accordance with some embodiments.

(12) Elements in the figures are illustrated for simplicity and clarity and have not necessarily been drawn to scale. For example, the dimensions and/or relative positioning of some of the elements in the figures may be exaggerated relative to other elements to help to improve understanding of various embodiments of the present invention. Also, common but well-understood elements that are useful or necessary in a commercially feasible embodiment are often not depicted in order to facilitate a less obstructed view of these various embodiments of the present invention. Certain actions and/or steps may be described or depicted in a particular order of occurrence while those skilled in the art will understand that such specificity with respect to sequence is not actually required. The terms and expressions used herein have the ordinary technical meaning as is accorded to such terms and expressions by persons skilled in the technical field as set forth above except where different specific meanings have otherwise been set forth herein.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(13) Generally speaking, pursuant to various embodiments, systems, apparatuses and methods are provided herein useful for processing captured images of objects at a product storage facility. In some embodiments, a system for processing captured images of objects at a product storage facility includes a memory configured to store a plurality of images. The plurality of images may include first images and second images. Each of the first images may contain items not detected by a trained machine learning product recognition model as being associated with a recognized product identifier. Each of the second images may contain items detected by the trained machine learning product recognition model as being associated with multiple recognized product identifiers. In some embodiments, a control circuit executing the trained machine learning product recognition model is configured to: allocate each of the first images into one of a plurality of datasets based on areas in the product storage facility the first images were captured. Alternatively or in addition to, for each dataset of the plurality of datasets, the control circuit executing the trained machine learning product recognition model may cluster each image in the dataset into one of a plurality of groups based on a degree of resemblance of items depicted in the image relative to those items depicted in other images in the dataset. Alternatively or in addition to, the control circuit executing the trained machine learning product recognition model may select a sample from at least one of the plurality of groups. Alternatively or in addition to, the control circuit executing the trained machine learning product recognition model may cluster each of the second images into one of dominant product identifier group and a non-dominant product identifier group. Alternatively or in addition to, the control circuit executing the trained machine learning product recognition model may select a sample from the dominant product identifier group. Alternatively or in addition to, the control circuit executing the trained machine learning product recognition model may select a sample from the non-dominant product identifier group. Alternatively or in addition to, the control circuit executing the trained machine learning product recognition model may output the selected sample from the at least one of the plurality of groups, the selected sample from the dominant product identifier group, and the selected sample from the non-dominant product identifier group to be used to retrain the trained machine learning product recognition model.

(14) In some embodiments, a method for processing captured images of objects at a product storage facility. The method may include storing, by a memory, a plurality of images. In some embodiments, the plurality of images include first images and second images. Each of the first images may contain items not detected by a trained machine learning product recognition model as being associated with a recognized product identifier. Each of the second images may contain items detected by the trained machine learning product recognition model as being associated with multiple recognized product identifiers. Alternatively or in addition to, the method may include allocating, by a control circuit executing the trained machine learning product recognition model, each of the first images into one of a plurality of datasets based on areas in the product storage

facility the first images were captured. Alternatively or in addition to, the method may include for each dataset of the plurality of datasets, clustering, by a control circuit executing the trained machine learning product recognition model, each image in the dataset into one of a plurality of groups based on a degree of resemblance of items depicted in the image relative to those items depicted in other images in the dataset. Alternatively or in addition to, the method may include selecting, by a control circuit executing the trained machine learning product recognition model, a sample from at least one of the plurality of groups. Alternatively or in addition to, the method may include clustering, by a control circuit executing the trained machine learning product recognition model, each of the second images into one of dominant product identifier group and a non-dominant product identifier group. Alternatively or in addition to, the method may include selecting, by a control circuit executing the trained machine learning product recognition model, a sample from the dominant product identifier group. Alternatively or in addition to, the method may include selecting, by a control circuit executing the trained machine learning product recognition model, a sample from the non-dominant product identifier group. Alternatively or in addition to, the method may include outputting, by a control circuit executing the trained machine learning product recognition model, the selected sample from the at least one of the plurality of groups, the selected sample from the dominant product identifier group, and the selected sample from the non-dominant product identifier group to be used to retrain the trained machine learning product recognition model.

(15) FIG. 1 shows an embodiment of a system **100** of updating inventory of products for sale and stored at product storage areas **110** and/or on product storage structures **115** of a product storage facility **105** (which may be a retail store, a product distribution center, a fulfillment center, a warehouse, etc.). The system **100** is illustrated in FIG. 1 for simplicity with only one movable image capture device **120** that moves about one product storage area **110** containing three separate product storage structures **115a**, **115b**, and **115c**, but it will be appreciated that, depending on the size of the product storage facility, the system **100** may include multiple movable image capture devices **120** located throughout the product storage facility that monitor hundreds of product storage areas **110** and thousands of product storage structures **115a-115c**. It is understood that the movement about the product storage area **110** by the image capture device(s) **120** may depend on the physical arrangement of the product storage area **110** and/or the size and shape of the product storage structure **115**. For example, the image capture device **120** may move linearly down an aisle alongside a product storage structure **115** (e.g., a shelving unit), or may move in a circular fashion around a table having curved or multiple sides.

(16) Notably, the term “product storage structure” as used herein generally refers to a structure on which products **190a-190c** are stored, and may include a rack, a pallet, a shelf cabinet, a single shelf, a shelving unit, table, rack, displays, bins, gondola, case, countertop, or another product display. Likewise, it will be appreciated that the number of individual products **190a-190c** representing three exemplary distinct products (labeled as “Cereal 1,” “Cereal 2,” and “Cereal 3”) is chosen by way of example only. Further, the size and shape of the products **190a-190c** in FIG. 1 have been shown by way of example only, and it will be appreciated that the individual products **190a-190c** may have various sizes and shapes. Notably, the term products **190** may refer to individual products **190** (some of which may be single-piece/single-component products and some of which may be multi-piece/multi-component products), as well as to packages or containers of products **190**, which may be plastic- or paper-based packaging that includes multiple units of a given product **190** (e.g., a plastic wrap that includes 36 rolls of identical paper towels, a paper box that includes 10 packs of identical diapers, etc.). Alternatively, the packaging of the individual products **190** may be a plastic- or paper-based container that encloses one individual product **190** (e.g., a box of cereal, a bottle of shampoo, etc.).

(17) The image capture device **120** (also referred to as an image capture unit) of the exemplary system **100** depicted in FIG. 1 is configured to move around the product storage facility (e.g., on

the floor via a motorized or non-motorized wheel-based/track-based locomotion system, via slidable tracks above the floor, via a toothed metal wheel/linked metal tracks system, etc.) such that, when moving (e.g., about an aisle or other area of a product storage facility **105**), the image capture device **120** has a field of view that includes at least a portion of one or more of the product storage structures **115a-115c** within a given product storage area **110** of the product storage facility **105**, permitting the image capture device **120** to capture multiple images of the product storage area **110** from various viewing angles. In some embodiments, the image capture device **120** is configured as a robotic device that moves without being physically operated/manipulated by a human operator (as described in more detail below). In other embodiments, the image capture device **120** is configured to be driven or manually pushed (e.g., like a cart or the like) by a human operator. In still further embodiments, the image capture device **120** may be a hand-held or a wearable device (e.g., a camera, phone, tablet, or the like) that may be carried and/or work by a worker at the product storage facility **105** while the worker moves about the product storage facility **105**. In some embodiments, the image capture device **120** may be incorporated into another mobile device (e.g., a floor cleaner, floor sweeper, forklift, etc.), the primary purpose of which is independent of capturing images of product storage areas **110** of the product storage facility **105**. (18) In some embodiments, as will be described in more detail below, the images of the product storage area **110** captured by the image capture device **120** while moving about the product storage area are transmitted by the image capture device **120** over a network **130** to an electronic database **140** and/or to a computing device **150**. In some aspects, the computing device **150** (or a separate image processing internet-based/cloud-based service module) is configured to process such images as will be described in more detail below.

(19) The exemplary system **100** shown in FIG. **1** includes an electronic database **140**. Generally, the exemplary electronic database **140** may be configured as a single database, or a collection of multiple communicatively connected databases (e.g., digital image database, meta data database, inventory database, pricing database, customer database, vendor database, manufacturer database, etc.) and is configured to store various raw and processed images of the product storage area **110** captured by the image capture device **120** while the image capture device **120** may be moving around the product storage facility **105**. In some embodiments, the electronic database **140** and the computing device **150** may be implemented as two separate physical devices located at the product storage facility **105**. It will be appreciated, however, that the computing device **150** and the electronic database **140** may be implemented as a single physical device and/or may be located at different (e.g., remote) locations relative to each other and relative to the product storage facility **105**. In some aspects, the electronic database **140** may be stored, for example, on non-volatile storage media (e.g., a hard drive, flash drive, or removable optical disk) internal or external to the computing device **150**, or internal or external to computing devices distinct from the computing device **150**. In some embodiments, the electronic database **140** may be cloud-based. In some embodiments, the electronic database **140** may include one or more memory devices, computer data storage, and/or cloud-based data storage configured to store one or more of product inventories, pricing, and/or demand, and/or customer, vendor, and/or manufacturer data.

(20) The system **100** of FIG. **1** further includes a computing device **150** configured to communicate with the electronic database **140**, user devices **160**, and/or internet-based services **170**, and the image capture device **120** over the network **130**. The exemplary network **130** depicted in FIG. **1** may be a wide-area network (WAN), a local area network (LAN), a personal area network (PAN), a wireless local area network (WLAN), Wi-Fi, Zigbee, Bluetooth (e.g., Bluetooth Low Energy (BLE) network), or any other internet or intranet network, or combinations of such networks. Generally, communication between various electronic devices of system **100** may take place over hard-wired, wireless, cellular, Wi-Fi or Bluetooth networked components or the like. In some embodiments, one or more electronic devices of system **100** may include cloud-based features, such as cloud-based memory storage. In some embodiments, portions of the network **130** are located at or in the

product storage facility.

(21) The computing device **150** may be a stationary or portable electronic device, for example, a server, a cloud-server, a series of communicatively connected servers, a computer cluster, a desktop computer, a laptop computer, a tablet, a mobile phone, or any other electronic device including a control circuit (i.e., control unit) that includes a programmable processor. The computing device **150** may be configured for data entry and processing as well as for communication with other devices of system **100** via the network **130**. As mentioned above, the computing device **150** may be located at the same physical location as the electronic database **140**, or may be located at a remote physical location relative to the electronic database **140**.

(22) FIG. 2 presents a more detailed example of an exemplary motorized robotic image capture device **120**. As mentioned above, the image capture device **102** does not necessarily need an autonomous motorized wheel-based and/or track-based system to move around the product storage facility **105**, and may instead be moved (e.g., driven, pushed, carried, worn, etc.) by a human operator, or may be movably coupled to a track system (which may be above the floor level or at the floor level) that permits the image capture device **120** to move around the product storage facility **105** while capturing images of various product storage areas **110** of the product storage facility **105**. In the example shown in FIG. 2, the motorized image capture device **120** has a housing **202** that contains (partially or fully) or at least supports and carries a number of components. These components include a control unit **204** comprising a control circuit **206** that controls the general operations of the motorized image capture device **120** (notably, in some implementations, the control circuit **310** of the computing device **150** may control the general operations of the image capture device **120**). Accordingly, the control unit **204** also includes a memory **208** coupled to the control circuit **206** and that stores, for example, computer program code, operating instructions and/or useful data, which when executed by the control circuit implement the operations of the image capture device.

(23) The control circuit **206** of the exemplary motorized image capture device **120** of FIG. 2, operably couples to a motorized wheel system **210**, which, as pointed out above, is optional (and for this reason represented by way of dashed lines in FIG. 2). This motorized wheel system **210** functions as a locomotion system to permit the image capture device **120** to move within the product storage facility **105** (thus, the motorized wheel system **210** may be more generically referred to as a locomotion system). Generally, this motorized wheel system **210** may include at least one drive wheel (i.e., a wheel that rotates around a horizontal axis) under power to thereby cause the image capture device **120** to move through interaction with, e.g., the floor of the product storage facility. The motorized wheel system **210** can include any number of rotating wheels and/or other alternative floor-contacting mechanisms (e.g., tracks, etc.) as may be desired and/or appropriate to the application setting.

(24) The motorized wheel system **210** may also include a steering mechanism of choice. One simple example may comprise one or more wheels that can swivel about a vertical axis to thereby cause the moving image capture device **120** to turn as well. It should be appreciated the motorized wheel system **210** may be any suitable motorized wheel and track system known in the art capable of permitting the image capture device **120** to move within the product storage facility **105**. Further elaboration in these regards is not provided here for the sake of brevity save to note that the aforementioned control circuit **206** is configured to control the various operating states of the motorized wheel system **210** to thereby control when and how the motorized wheel system **210** operates.

(25) In the exemplary embodiment of FIG. 2, the control circuit **206** operably couples to at least one wireless transceiver **212** that operates according to any known wireless protocol. This wireless transceiver **212** can comprise, for example, a Wi-Fi-compatible and/or Bluetooth-compatible transceiver (or any other transceiver operating according to known wireless protocols) that can wirelessly communicate with the aforementioned computing device **150** via the aforementioned

network **130** of the product storage facility. So configured, the control circuit **206** of the image capture device **120** can provide information to the computing device **150** (via the network **130**) and can receive information and/or movement instructions (instructions from the computing device **150**). For example, the control circuit **206** can receive instructions from the computing device **150** via the network **130** regarding directional movement (e.g., specific predetermined routes of movement) of the image capture device **120** throughout the space of the product storage facility **105**. These teachings will accommodate using any of a wide variety of wireless technologies as desired and/or as may be appropriate in a given application setting. These teachings will also accommodate employing two or more different wireless transceivers **212**, if desired.

(26) In the embodiment illustrated in FIG. 2, the control circuit **206** also couples to one or more on-board sensors **214** of the image capture device **120**. These teachings will accommodate a wide variety of sensor technologies and form factors. According to some embodiments, the image capture device **120** can include one or more sensors **214** including but not limited to an optical sensor, a photo sensor, an infrared sensor, a 3-D sensor, a depth sensor, a digital camera sensor, a mobile electronic device (e.g., a cell phone, tablet, or the like), a quick response (QR) code sensor, a radio frequency identification (RFID) sensor, a near field communication (NFC) sensor, a stock keeping unit (SKU) sensor, a barcode (e.g., electronic product code (EPC), universal product code (UPC), European article number (EAN), global trade item number (GTIN)) sensor, or the like.

(27) By one optional approach, an audio input **216** (such as a microphone) and/or an audio output **218** (such as a speaker) can also operably couple to the control circuit **206**. So configured, the control circuit **206** can provide a variety of audible sounds to thereby communicate with workers at the product storage facility or other motorized image capture devices **120** moving around the product storage facility **105**. These audible sounds can include any of a variety of tones and other non-verbal sounds. Such audible sounds can also include, in lieu of the foregoing or in combination therewith, pre-recorded or synthesized speech.

(28) The audio input **216**, in turn, provides a mechanism whereby, for example, a user (e.g., a worker at the product storage facility **105**) provides verbal input to the control circuit **206**. That verbal input can comprise, for example, instructions, inquiries, or information. So configured, a user can provide, for example, an instruction and/or query (e.g., where is pallet number so-and-so?, how many products are stocked on pallet number so-and-so? etc.) to the control circuit **206** via the audio input **216**.

(29) In the embodiment illustrated in FIG. 2, the motorized image capture device **120** includes a rechargeable power source **220** such as one or more batteries. The power provided by the rechargeable power source **220** can be made available to whichever components of the motorized image capture device **120** require electrical energy. By one approach, the motorized image capture device **120** includes a plug or other electrically conductive interface that the control circuit **206** can utilize to automatically connect to an external source of electrical energy to thereby recharge the rechargeable power source **220**.

(30) In some embodiments, the motorized image capture device **120** includes an input/output (I/O) device **224** that is coupled to the control circuit **206**. The I/O device **224** allows an external device to couple to the control unit **204**. The function and purpose of connecting devices will depend on the application. In some examples, devices connecting to the I/O device **224** may add functionality to the control unit **204**, allow the exporting of data from the control unit **206**, allow the diagnosing of the motorized image capture device **120**, and so on.

(31) In some embodiments, the motorized image capture device **120** includes a user interface **224** including for example, user inputs and/or user outputs or displays depending on the intended interaction with the user (e.g., worker at the product storage facility **105**). For example, user inputs could include any input device such as buttons, knobs, switches, touch sensitive surfaces or display screens, and so on. Example user outputs include lights, display screens, and so on. The user interface **224** may work together with or separate from any user interface implemented at an

optional user interface unit or user device **160** (such as a smart phone or tablet device) usable by a worker at the product storage facility. In some embodiments, the user interface **224** is separate from the image capture device **202**, e.g., in a separate housing or device wired or wirelessly coupled to the image capture device **202**. In some embodiments, the user interface may be implemented in a mobile user device **160** carried by a person and configured for communication over the network **130** with the image capture device **102**.

(32) In some embodiments, the motorized image capture device **120** may be controlled by the computing device **150** or a user (e.g., by driving or pushing the image capture device **120** or sending control signals to the image capture device **120** via the user device **160**) on-site at the product storage facility **105** or off-site. This is due to the architecture of some embodiments where the computing device **150** and/or user device **160** outputs the control signals to the motorized image capture device **120**. These controls signals can originate at any electronic device in communication with the computing device **150** and/or motorized image capture device **120**. For example, the movement signals sent to the motorized image capture device **120** may be movement instructions determined by the computing device **150**; commands received at the user device **160** from a user; and commands received at the computing device **150** from a remote user not located at the product storage facility **105**.

(33) In the embodiment illustrated in FIG. 2, the control unit **204** includes a memory **208** coupled to the control circuit **206** and that stores, for example, computer program code, operating instructions and/or useful data, which when executed by the control circuit implement the operations of the image capture device. The control circuit **206** can comprise a fixed-purpose hard-wired platform or can comprise a partially or wholly programmable platform. These architectural options are well known and understood in the art and require no further description here. This control circuit **206** is configured (for example, by using corresponding programming stored in the memory **208** as will be well understood by those skilled in the art) to carry out one or more of the steps, actions, and/or functions described herein. The memory **208** may be integral to the control circuit **206** or can be physically discrete (in whole or in part) from the control circuit **206** as desired. This memory **208** can also be local with respect to the control circuit **206** (where, for example, both share a common circuit board, chassis, power supply, and/or housing) or can be partially or wholly remote with respect to the control circuit **206**. This memory **208** can serve, for example, to non-transitorily store the computer instructions that, when executed by the control circuit **206**, cause the control circuit **206** to behave as described herein.

(34) In some embodiments, the control circuit **206** may be communicatively coupled to one or more trained computer vision/machine learning/neural network modules **222** to perform at some of the functions. For example, the control circuit **206** may be trained to process one or more images of product storage areas **110** at the product storage facility **105** to detect and/or recognize one or more products **190** using one or more machine learning algorithms, including but not limited to Linear Regression, Logistic Regression, Decision Tree, SVM, Naïve Bayes, kNN, K-Means, Random Forest, Dimensionality Reduction Algorithms, Gradient Boosting Algorithms, Convolutional Neural Network (CNN), Recurrent Neural Network (RNN), Deep Neural Network (DNN), and/or algorithms associated with neural networks. In some embodiments, the trained machine learning model **222** includes a computer program code stored in a memory **208** and/or executed by the control circuit **206** to process one or more images, as described in more detail below.

(35) It is noted that not all components illustrated in FIG. 2 are included in all embodiments of the motorized image capture device **120**. That is, some components may be optional depending on the implementation of the motorized image capture device **120**.

(36) With reference to FIG. 3, the exemplary computing device **150** configured for use with exemplary systems and methods described herein may include a control circuit **310** including a programmable processor (e.g., a microprocessor or a microcontroller) electrically coupled via a connection **315** to a memory **320** and via a connection **325** to a power supply **330**. The control

circuit **310** can comprise a fixed-purpose hard-platform or can comprise a partially or wholly programmable platform, such as a microcontroller, an application specification integrated circuit, a field programmable gate array, and so on. These architectural options are well known and understood in the art and require no further description here.

(37) The control circuit **310** can be configured (for example, by using corresponding programming stored in the memory **320** as will be well understood by those skilled in the art) to carry out one or more of the steps, actions, and/or functions described herein. In some embodiments, the memory **320** may be integral to the processor-based control circuit **310** or can be physically discrete (in whole or in part) from the control circuit **310** and is configured non-transitorily store the computer instructions that, when executed by the control circuit **310**, cause the control circuit **310** to behave as described herein. (As used herein, this reference to “non-transitorily” will be understood to refer to a non-ephemeral state for the stored contents (and hence excludes when the stored contents merely constitute signals or waves) rather than volatility of the storage media itself and hence includes both non-volatile memory (such as read-only memory (ROM)) as well as volatile memory (such as an erasable programmable read-only memory (EPROM))). Accordingly, the memory and/or the control unit may be referred to as a non-transitory medium or non-transitory computer readable medium.

(38) The control circuit **310** of the computing device **150** is also electrically coupled via a connection **335** to an input/output **340** that can receive signals from, for example, from the image capture device **120**, etc., the electronic database **140**, internet-based services **170** (e.g., image processing services, computer vision services, neural network services, etc.), and/or from another electronic device (e.g., an electronic or user device of a worker tasked with physically inspecting the product storage area **110** and/or the product storage structures **115a-115c** and observe the individual products **190a-190c** stocked thereon. The input/output **340** of the computing device **150** can also send signals to other devices, for example, a signal to the electronic database **140** including an image of a given product storage structure **115b** selected by the control circuit **310** of the computing device **150** as fully showing the product storage structure **115b** and each of the products **190b** stored in the product storage structure **115b**. Also, a signal may be sent by the computing device **150** via the input-output **340** to the image capture device **120** to, for example, provide a route of movement for the image capture device **120** through the product storage facility.

(39) The processor-based control circuit **310** of the computing device **150** shown in FIG. 3 may be electrically or wirelessly coupled via a connection **345** to a user interface **350**, which may include a visual display or display screen **360** (e.g., LED screen) and/or button input **370** that provide the user interface **350** with the ability to permit a user (e.g., worker at a the product storage facility **105** or a worker at a remote regional center) to access the computing device **150** by inputting commands via touch-screen and/or button operation and/or voice commands. Possible commands may for example, cause the computing device **150** to cause transmission of an alert signal to an electronic mobile user device **160** of a worker at the product storage facility **105** to assign a task to the worker that requires the worker to visually inspect and/or restock a given product storage structure **115a-115c** based on analysis by the computing device **150** of the image of the product storage structure **115a-115c** captured by the image capture device **120**.

(40) In some embodiments, the user interface **350** of the computing device **150** may also include a speaker **380** that provides audible feedback (e.g., alerts) to the operator of the computing device **150**. It will be appreciated that the performance of such functions by the processor-based control circuit **310** of the computing device **150** is not dependent on a human operator, and that the control circuit **210** may be programmed to perform such functions without a human user.

(41) As pointed out above, in some embodiments, the image capture device **120** moves around the product storage facility **105** (while being controlled remotely by the computing device **150** (or another remote device such as the user device **160**), or while being controlled autonomously by the control circuit **206** of the image capture device **120**), or while being manually driven or pushed by a

worker of the product storage facility **105**. When the image capture device **120** moves about the product storage area **110** as shown in FIG. **1**, the sensor **214** of the image capture device **120**, which may be one or more digital cameras, captures (in sequence) multiple images of the product storage area **110** from various angles. In some aspects, the control circuit **310** of the computing device **150** obtains (e.g., from the electronic database **140** or directly from the image capture device **120**) the images of the product storage area **110** captured by the image capture device **120** while moving about the product storage area **110**.

(42) The sensor **214** (e.g., digital camera) of the image capture device **120** is located and/or oriented on the image capture device **120** such that, when the image capture device **120** moves about the product storage area **110**, the field of view of the sensor **214** includes only portions of adjacent product storage structures **115a-115c**, or an entire product storage structure **115a-115c**. In certain aspects, the image capture device **120** is configured to move about the product storage area **110** while capturing images of the product storage structures **115a-115c** at certain predetermined time intervals (e.g., every 1 second, 5 seconds, 10 seconds, etc.).

(43) The images captured by the image capture device **120** may be transmitted to the electronic database **140** for storage and/or to the computing device **150** for processing by the control circuit **310** and/or to a web-/cloud-based image processing service **170**. In some embodiments, one or more of the image capture devices **120** of the exemplary system **100** depicted in FIG. **1** is mounted on or coupled to a motorized robotic unit similar to the motorized robotic image capture device **120** of FIG. **2**.

(44) In some embodiments, one or more of the image capture devices **120** of the exemplary system **100** depicted in FIG. **1** is configured to be stationary or mounted to a structure, such that the image capture device **120** may capture one or more images of an area having one or more products at the product storage facility. For example, the area may include a product storage area **110**, and/or a portion of and/or an entire product storage structures **115a-115c** of the product storage facility.

(45) In some embodiments, the electronic database **140** stores data corresponding to the inventory of products in the product storage facility. The control circuit **310** processes the images captured by the image capture device **120** and causes an update to the inventory of products in the electronic database **140**. In some embodiments, one or more steps in the processing of the images are via machine learning and/or computer vision models that may include one or more trained neural network models. In certain aspects, the neural network may be a deep convolutional neural network. The neural network may be trained using various data sets, including, but not limited to: raw image data extracted from the images captured by the image capture device **120**; metadata extracted from the images captured by the image capture device **120**; reference image data associated with reference images of various product storage structures **115a-115c** at the product storage facility; reference images of various products **190a-190c** stocked and/or sold at the product storage facility; and/or planogram data associated with the product storage facility.

(46) FIG. **4** illustrates a simplified block diagram of an exemplary system for labeling objects in images captured at one or more product storage facilities in accordance with some embodiments. The system **400** includes a control circuit **310**. Alternatively or in addition to, the system **400** may include memory storage/s **402**, a user interface **350**, and/or product storage facilities **105** coupled via a network **130**. In some embodiments, the memory storage/s **402** may be one or more of a cloud storage network, a solid state drive, a hard drive, a random access memory (RAM), a read only memory (ROM), and/or any storage devices capable of storing electronic data, or any combination thereof. In some embodiments, the memory storage/s **402** includes the memory **320**. In such an embodiment, a trained machine learning model **404** includes trained machine learning model/s **390**. In some embodiments, the memory storage/s **402** is separate and distinct from the memory **320**. In such an embodiment, the trained machine learning model **404** may be associated with the trained machine learning model/s **390**. For example, the trained machine learning model/s **390** may be a copied version of the trained machine learning model **404**. Alternatively or in addition to, the

trained machine learning model **222** may be a copied version of the trained machine learning model **404**. In some embodiments, the processing of unprocessed captured images is processed by the trained machine learning model **222**.

(47) In some embodiments, the memory storage/s **402** includes a trained machine learning model **404** and/or a database **140**. In some embodiments, the database **140** may be an organized collection of structured information, or data, typically stored electronically in a computer system (e.g. the system **100**). In some embodiments, the database **140** may be controlled by a database management system (DBMS). In some embodiments, the DBMS may include the control circuit **310**. In yet some embodiments, the DBMS may include another control circuit (not shown) separate and/or distinct from the control circuit **310**.

(48) In some embodiments, the control circuit **310** may be communicatively coupled to the trained machine learning model **404** including one or more trained computer vision/machine learning/neural network modules to perform at some or all of the functions described herein. For example, the control circuit **310** using the trained machine learning model **404** may be trained to process one or more images of product storage areas (e.g., aisles, racks, shelves, pallets, to name a few) at product storage facilities **105** to detect and/or recognize one or more products for purchase using one or more machine learning algorithms, including but not limited to Linear Regression, Logistic Regression, Decision Tree, SVM, Naïve Bayes, kNN, K-Means, Random Forest, Dimensionality Reduction Algorithms, Gradient Boosting Algorithms, Convolutional Neural Network (CNN), Recurrent Neural Network (RNN), Deep Neural Network (DNN), and/or algorithms associated with neural networks. In some embodiments, the trained machine learning model **404** includes a computer program code stored in the memory storage/s **402** and/or executed by the control circuit **310** to process one or more images, as described herein.

(49) The product storage facility **105** may include one of a retail store, a distribution center, and/or a fulfillment center. In some embodiments, a user interface **350** includes an application stored in a memory (e.g., the memory **320** or the memory storage/s **402**) and executable by the control circuit **310**. In some embodiments, the user interface **350** may be coupled to the control circuit **310** and may be used by a user to at least one of associate a product with at least one depicted object in processed images or resolve that one or more objects depicted in the images is only associated with a single product. In some embodiments, an output of the user interface **350** is used to retrain the trained machine learning model **404**.

(50) In some embodiments, the trained machine learning model **404** processes unprocessed captured images. For example, unprocessed captured images may include images captured by and/or output by the image capture device/s **120**. Alternatively or in addition to, the unprocessed captured images may include images that have not gone through object detection or object classification by the control circuit **310**. In some embodiments, at least some of the unprocessed captured images depict objects in the product storage facility **105**.

(51) Illustrative non-limiting exemplary processing of captured images of objects at one or more product storage facilities **105** are described in FIGS. 5 through 9. FIG. 5 illustrates an exemplary system **500** for processing captured images of objects at one or more product storage facilities **105** in accordance with some embodiments. FIG. 6 shows a flow diagram of an exemplary method **600** of processing captured images of objects at one or more product storage facilities **105** in accordance with some embodiments. FIG. 7 illustrates an exemplary system **700** for processing captured images of objects at a product storage facility in accordance with some embodiments. FIG. 8 shows a flow diagram of an exemplary method **800** of processing captured images of objects at a product storage facility in accordance with some embodiments. FIG. 9 shows a flow diagram of an exemplary method **900** of processing captured images of objects at a product storage facility in accordance with some embodiments.

(52) In some embodiments, a memory (e.g., the memory storage/s **402** and/or the database **140**), at step **902**, stores a plurality of images. For example, the plurality of images may include first images

and/or second images. Each of the first images may contain items not detected by the trained machine learning model **404** and/or the control circuit **310** as being associated with a recognized product identifier. For example, the control circuit **310** and/or the trained machine learning model **404** may detect that there is an object (e.g., an item of a product) on an image. However, the control circuit **310** and/or the trained machine learning model **404** may not be able to identify or recognize what kind of product the object is since the control circuit **310** and/or the trained machine learning model **404** could not determine or recognize a product identifier associated with the object.

(53) In some embodiments, each of the second images may contain items detected by the trained machine learning model **404** and/or the control circuit **310** as being associated with multiple recognized product identifiers. For example, the trained machine learning model **404** and/or the control circuit **310** may detect that there are multiple objects that may be clustered on an image. However, the control circuit **310** and/or the trained machine learning model **404** may determine or recognize more than one product identifier associated with the objects in the cluster.

(54) In an illustrative non-limiting example, the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404** may access the memory to obtain a plurality of images or receive the plurality of images captured by the image capture device/s **120**. In some embodiments, the plurality of images are images captured by various image capture device/s **120** located in a plurality of areas in various product storage facilities **105**. For example, the plurality of areas may include one of an aisle, a bin, a pallet, and/or a rack storing one or more office supply products, grocery products, electronic products, and/or household supply products and/or located in designated retail areas (e.g., baking aisle, beverage aisle, bread aisle, breakfast cereal aisle, candy and snack aisle, canned goods aisle, condiment aisle, dairy aisle, boxed dinners and pasta aisle, paper products and cleaning supplies aisle, personal care products aisle, fresh fruit and veggies section, fresh meat section, and bread and baker section, to name a few).

(55) In some embodiments, the plurality of images may include huge or voluminous images captured from a number of or all product storage facilities **105** associated with a retailer. In some embodiments, the captured images depict various products for purchase that are stored and/or sold at the product storage facilities **105** of the retailer. In some embodiments, some of the products depicted on the captured images may not be recognized by the trained machine learning model **404**. As such, the control circuit **310** may need to retrain the trained machine learning model **404** in order for the trained machine learning model **404** to recognize these products the next time these products are presented to the trained machine learning model **404** for recognition and/or identification. In an illustrative non-limiting example, to automatically retrain the trained machine learning model **404**, the control circuit **310** using the trained machine learning model **404** may group similar images of the plurality of images together and select sample images from the grouped similar images as illustrated in FIGS. 5-10. Thus, the trained machine learning model **404** is retrained using the selected sample images instead of the plurality of images, which can be voluminous requiring lots of resources (computer and/or manpower) to process in order to retrain a trained machine learning model **404**.

(56) In an illustrative non-limiting example, FIGS. 5 and 6 illustrate grouping **504** similar images of the plurality of images together and selecting **506** sample images from the grouped similar images. In some embodiments, the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404**, at step **904**, allocates each of first images **502** into one of a plurality of datasets based on areas in a product storage facility **105** the first images **502** were captured.

(57) For example, a first image **508** is an image that may be captured at the baking aisle of a first product storage facility **105** while a second image **510** is an image that may be captured at the baking aisle of a second product storage facility **105**. Another example, a third image **512** is another image that may be captured at the paper products and cleaning supplies aisle of the first product storage facility **105** while a fourth image **514** is another image that may be captured at the paper products and cleaning supplies aisle of the second product storage facility **105**. As such, the control

circuit **310** and/or the trained machine learning model **404** may allocate the first image **508** and the second image **510** with baking aisle dataset while the third image **512** and the fourth image **514** with paper products and cleaning supplies aisle dataset.

(58) In some embodiments, the trained machine learning model **404** is not able to determine or predict a product identifier for the images **508**, **510**, **512**, **514**. In such embodiments, the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404** may group images **508**, **510**, **512**, **514** based on textual and/or visual features of the objects depicted in the images **508**, **510**, **512**, **514**. The control circuit **310** may use publicly known optical character recognition (OCR) and/or feature vector embedding image processing techniques to group images.

(59) Continuing the illustrative non-limiting example above, for each dataset of the plurality of datasets, the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404**, at step **906**, may cluster each image in the dataset into one of a plurality of groups based on a degree of resemblance of items depicted in the image relative to those items depicted in other images in the dataset. In some embodiments, the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404** may determine the degree of resemblance of items based on at least one of a textual similarity or a visual similarity of the items depicted in the images allocated to the same dataset. For example, the control circuit **310** and/or the trained machine learning model **404** may determine how textually and/or visually similar the first image **508** is with the second image **510**.

(60) In some embodiments, the plurality of groups that an image may be clustered to include a homogenous group, a heterogeneous group, a low similarity group, and/or an individual group. For example, for the baking aisle dataset, the first image **508** and the second image **510** may be clustered into the homogenous group since the objects depicted in both the first image **508** and the second image **510** are more than 70% textually and/or visually similar. In such example, a homogenous group may include images where the degree of resemblance of items or objects depicted in each image is greater than 70%. It should be appreciated that the threshold for a homogenous grouping may vary in alternative embodiments (e.g., greater than 50%, greater than 60%, greater than 80%, etc.).

(61) In another example, for the paper products and cleaning supplies aisle dataset, the third image **512** and the fourth image **514** may clustered into the heterogeneous group since the objects depicted in both the third image **512** and the fourth image **514** are at least 30% but no more than 70% textually and/or visually similar. In such example, a heterogeneous group may include images where the degree of resemblance of items or objects depicted in each image is at least 30% but no more than 70% textually and/or visually similar. It should be appreciated that the range for a heterogeneous grouping may vary in alternative embodiments (e.g., at least 20% but no more than 80%, at least 10% but no more than 70%, etc.).

(62) In some embodiments, images clustered into a low similarity group may include images where the degree of resemblance (for example, textually and/or visually) of items or objects depicted in each image is less than 30%. In some embodiments, images clustered into an individual group may include images which do not have resemblance with any other image in the dataset. For example, each image in the individual group does not have resemblance with one another nor resemblance with other images in the other group (e.g., the homogenous group, the heterogeneous group, and the low similarity group). It should be appreciated that the threshold for a low similarity grouping may vary in alternative embodiments (e.g., less than 20%, less than 10%, etc.).

(63) Alternatively or in addition to, the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404**, at step **908**, may select a sample from at least one of the plurality of groups. In some embodiments, the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404** may select a sample from each of the plurality of groups. Alternatively or in addition to, the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404** may output the selected sample to retrain the trained machine learning model **404**. In some embodiments, the selected sample from at least one of the plurality of groups includes a sample of one or more images based on a rule. Alternatively or

in addition to, the selected sample includes a sample of one or more images from each of the plurality of groups based on the rule.

(64) In some embodiments, for images included in the homogenous group, the rule may include selecting, by the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404**, at least two or three images based on a highest number of at least one of depicted bounding boxes, boundary box aspect ratio (e.g., different height and width ratio of box may indicate different facings of the same product), or Optical Character Recognition (OCR) count (e.g., text count).

(65) In some embodiments, for images included in the heterogeneous group, the rule may include selecting, by the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404**, a predetermined percentage of the images included in the heterogeneous group. For example, the percentage value of images to include may be determined by conducting experiments on sample data optimising for UPC and/or product identifier coverage.

(66) In some embodiments, for images included in the individual group, the rule may include selecting, by the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404**, all images included in the individual group.

(67) In yet some embodiments, the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404** may process each image included in the low similarity group by determining the degree of resemblance of items or objects depicted in the image, and/or clustering the image into one of the homogenous group, the heterogeneous group, the low similarity group, or the individual group in accordance with the determined degree of resemblance of the items. Alternatively or in addition to, the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404** may repeatedly process subsequent images included in the low similarity group until each of the subsequent images is clustered into one of the homogenous group, the heterogeneous group, or the individual group in accordance with the determined degree of resemblance of the items. In some embodiments, the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404** may repeatedly process subsequent images included in the low similarity group until there is no more images to be clustered in the low similarity group.

(68) In some embodiments, the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404** may group a sample of one or more images from each of the plurality of groups into a selected sample based on the rule. In such embodiments, the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404** may output the selected sample to retrain the trained machine learning model in response to a determination that an image count of the selected sample is less than a threshold. For example, the threshold value may be determined by experimenting on sample datasets optimising for UPC and/or product identifier coverage, process runtime and/or computational memory usage.

(69) Alternatively or in addition to, in response to the determination that the image count of the selected sample is at least the threshold (e.g., equal to and/or greater than the threshold), the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404** may allocate each image in the selected sample into one of the plurality of datasets based on the areas in the product storage facility **105** the images in the selected sample were captured. In some embodiments, for each dataset of the plurality of datasets, the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404** may cluster each image in the dataset into one of the plurality of groups based on the degree of resemblance of items depicted in the image relative to those items depicted in other images in the dataset. Alternatively or in addition to, the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404** may select a second sample from at least one of the plurality of groups. Alternatively or in addition to, the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404** may determine whether a second image count of the second sample is less than the threshold. In some embodiments, the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404** may output the selected second sample from the at least one of the plurality of groups. In some embodiments, the allocation of each image in the selected second sample into one of the

plurality of datasets, the clustering of each image in the dataset into one of the plurality of groups, and/or the selection of a subsequent sample from at least one of the plurality of groups are repeated until the subsequent sample is less than the threshold.

(70) FIG. 6 illustrates another non-limiting example of processing captured images of objects at a product storage facility. In some embodiments, the control circuit 310 and/or the trained machine learning model 404, may process images captured at a plurality of product storage facilities 105 by performing object or item detection (e.g., object or item may be detected but not classified or recognized). In some embodiments, the control circuit 310 and/or the trained machine learning model 404, at step 602, may further process those images depicting unrecognized objects or items (i.e., those images depicting objects/items that are not associated with or estimated to be associated with recognized product identifiers). In some embodiments, the control circuit 310 and/or the trained machine learning model 404, at step 604, may sort and split image data. For example, the image data may be sorted with respect to the same product storage facility location (e.g., image data may be sorted by which product storage facility the image was captured). Alternatively or in addition to, once the image data is sorted, the image data, at step 606, may be split by the control circuit 310 and/or the trained machine learning model 404 into a predetermined equal parts. For example, each part may correspond to a dataset. Alternatively or in addition to, the control circuit 310 and/or the trained machine learning model 404, at step 608, may cluster each image in the dataset into at least one of a homogenous group, a heterogeneous group, a low similarity group, or an individual group based on a degree of resemblance of items depicted in the image relative to those items depicted in other images in the dataset as previously describe above.

(71) Alternatively or in addition to, for those images clustered in the low similarity group, the control circuit 310 and/or the trained machine learning model 404, at step 610, may repeat steps 604, 606, and 608 until there are no images that can be clustered in the low similarity group. Alternatively or in addition to, the control circuit 310 and/or the trained machine learning model 404, at step 612, may select a sample one or more images from each group based on the rule previously described above. In some embodiments, the control circuit 310 and/or the trained machine learning model 404, at step 614, may determine whether a total count of images in the selected sample (i.e., the sum of the selected sample images from all the group) is less than a threshold. In yet some embodiments, the control circuit 310 and/or the trained machine learning model 404, at step 614, may determine whether a count of images in each of the selected sample images is less than a threshold. Alternatively or in addition to, in response to the determination that the count of images is less than the threshold, the control circuit 310 and/or the trained machine learning model 404, at step 616, may output the selected sample images to retrain the trained machine learning model 404. Alternatively or in addition to, in response to the determination that the count of images is equal to or greater than the threshold, the control circuit 310 and/or the trained machine learning model 404, at step 618, may determine whether the steps 604, 606, and 608 have been repeated less than a second threshold (e.g., a predetermined depth threshold). In some embodiments, in response to the 604, 606, and 608 being repeated less than the second threshold, the control circuit 310 and/or the trained machine learning model 404, may repeat steps 604, 606, and 608 until the second threshold is satisfied. In such embodiments, the control circuit 310 and/or the trained machine learning model 404, at step 616, may output the selected sample images to retrain the trained machine learning model 404.

(72) In another illustrative non-limiting example, FIG. 7 illustrates grouping similar images of the plurality of images together and selecting sample images from the grouped similar images. In some embodiments, the memory (e.g., the memory storage/s 402 and/or the database 140), at step 902, stores a plurality of images including the first images and/or the second images. In some embodiments, each of the second images may contain items detected by the trained machine learning model 404 and/or the control circuit 310 as being associated with multiple recognized product identifiers as previously described above. In some embodiments, the control circuit 310

executing the trained machine learning model **404** may determine which one of the product identifiers associated with the objects/items depicted on an image is the most identified or recognized with the depicted objects/items relative to other identified product identifiers of the depicted items in the image. For example, a cluster **702** of objects/items is shown in FIG. 7. In some embodiments, the cluster **702** includes a number of recognized items (e.g., a first recognized item **704** and a second recognized item **706**).

(73) Alternatively or in addition to, the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404**, at step **910**, may cluster each of the second images into one of dominant product identifier group and a non-dominant product identifier group. In some embodiments, the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404** may cluster objects/items associated with the first recognized item **704** into a dominant product identifier group since the first recognized item **704** is most identified with the depicted objects/items in the cluster **702**. In some embodiments, the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404** may cluster objects/items associated with the second recognized item **706** into a non-dominant product identifier group since the second recognized item **706** is the least identified with the depicted objects/items in the cluster **702**.

(74) In an illustrative non-limiting example, the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404** may cluster each image based on the dominant product identifier identified with the depicted objects/items in the image. For example, in FIG. 7, the first recognized item **704** may be associated with the dominant product identifier. In such an example, all images being processed that may have the first recognized item **704** as the dominant product identifier may be grouped together. Moreover, the control circuit **310** and/or the trained machine learning model **404** may cluster other images into other groups based on corresponding dominant product identifiers. For example, a first group may be associated with images having a first particular product identifier dominantly or most depicted in each of the images in the first group. In another example, a second group may be associated with images having a second particular product identifier dominantly or most depicted in each of the images in the second group.

(75) In some embodiments, the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404**, at step **912**, may select a sample one or more images from each of the dominant product identifier groups. For example, for each dominant product identifier group, the selected sample may include at least an image having a threshold range of depicted items being associated with the dominant product identifier. In another example, for each dominant product identifier group, the selected sample may include a single image having a predetermined percentage of the dominant product identifier identified with the depicted objects/items in the image. Alternatively or in addition to, the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404** may output the selected sample from each of the dominant product identifier groups to retrain the trained machine learning model **404**.

(76) In another illustrative non-limiting example, the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404** may cluster each image based on the non-dominant product identifier identified with the depicted objects/items in the image. For example, in FIG. 7, the second recognized item **706** may be associated with the non-dominant product identifier. In such an example, all images being processed that may have the second recognized item **706** as the non-dominant product identifier may be grouped together. Moreover, the control circuit **310** and/or the trained machine learning model **404** may cluster other images into other groups based on corresponding non-dominant product identifiers. For example, a third group may be associated with images having a third particular product identifier least depicted in each of the images in the third group. In another example, a fourth group may be associated with images having a fourth particular product identifier least depicted in each of the images in the fourth group.

(77) In some embodiments, the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404**, at step **914**, may select a sample one or more images from each of the non-dominant product

identifier groups. For example, for each non-dominant product identifier group, the selected sample may include at least an image having a second threshold range of depicted items being associated with the non-dominant product identifier. In another example, for each non-dominant product identifier group, the selected sample may include a single image having a second predetermined percentage of the non-dominant product identifier identified with the depicted objects/items in the image. In yet another example, for each non-dominant product identifier group, the selected sample from the non-dominant product identifier groups include all images associated with the non-dominant product identifier groups. Alternatively or in addition to, the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404** may output the selected sample from each of the non-dominant product identifier groups to retrain the trained machine learning model **404**.

(78) Alternatively or in addition to, the control circuit **310** executing the trained machine learning model **404**, at step **916**, may output the selected sample from the at least one of the plurality of groups, the selected sample from the dominant product identifier group, and/or the selected sample from the non-dominant product identifier group to be used to retrain the trained machine learning model.

(79) FIG. **8** shows a flow diagram of an exemplary method **800** of processing captured images of objects at one or more product storage facilities **105** in accordance with some embodiments. In some embodiments, the method **800** includes, at step **802**, receiving a plurality of processed images including first images and second images. Alternatively or in addition to, the method **800** may include, at step **804**, sorting out by the control circuit **310** the first images from the second images. Each of the first images may contain items not detected by the trained machine learning model **404** as being associated with a recognized product identifier. Each of the second images may contain items detected by the trained machine learning model **404** as being associated with multiple recognized product identifiers. Alternatively or in addition to, the method **800** may include, at step **806**, executing the trained machine learning model **404** by the control circuit **310** to perform unsupervised data sampling logic. In some embodiments, for unrecognized item-clusters (i.e., the first images), at step **808**, the processing performed by the trained machine learning model **404** to narrow down the images used to retrain the trained machine learning model **404** or itself into a manageable quantity is at least described in FIGS. **5**, **6**, and **9** above. In some embodiments, for potential false positive clusters (i.e., the second images), at step **810**, the processing performed by the trained machine learning model **404** to narrow down the images used to retrain the trained machine learning model **404** or itself into a manageable quantity is at least described in FIGS. **7** and **9** above. In some embodiments, the selected samples output by the trained machine learning model **404** are provided to the user interface **350** for labeling and/or resolution.

(80) For example, at step **812**, the trained machine learning model **404** may predict and provide to the user interface **350** a listing of candidate product identifiers that may include the correct product identifier to label or associate with objects/items detected on the selected samples of the first images. In some embodiments, the listing of candidate product identifiers is displayed in the user interface **350** in an order of either decreasing or increasing confidence values associated with corresponding candidate product identifiers. In some embodiments, the confidence values are values determined by the trained machine learning model **404** indicating the likelihood that a particular candidate product identifier corresponds to the detected object/item on the image selected to be labeled by the user. As such, the training data used to train the trained machine learning model **404** is updated with each user-labeled objects/items on the image or the labeled image. The labeling of these previously unrecognized objects/items may allow the trained machine learning model **404** to be trained on new product identifiers, new products, and/or variations of products that may come into inventory after the initial training of the machine learning model. Additionally, the labeling of these previously unrecognized objects/items may allow the retraining of the trained machine learning model **404** to identify or recognize objects/items that it was previously trained on but was unable to identify or recognize.

(81) In another example, at step **814**, the user interface **350** may display the detected objects/items on the selected image of the second images along with the corresponding predictions determined by the trained machine learning model **404** that the objects/items are associated with a dominant product identifier group or a non-dominant product identifier group. As such, the user may confirm that the trained machine learning model **404** made a correct prediction or not. Additionally, the user may resolve whether there are indeed multiple product identifiers associated with the depicted objects/items in the image. Thus, the sampling of data may allow the user to assess the accuracy of the trained machine learning model **404** in identifying or recognizing an object or item depicted in an image, and/or provide or update the training data the trained machine learning model **404** is trained on.

(82) Moreover, the disclosures described herein provides several benefits. For example, the nested grouping logic used for unrecognized item clusters can group large number of images with significantly low runtime and computational memory and scales logarithmically with number of images. As such, system described herein can handle any number of shortlisted images when the trained machine learning model **404** is deployed in significant number of product storage facilities **105**. In another example, the group similarity-based image selection and dominant UPC or product identifier based image selection may ensure that best images are selected to represent each UPC or product identifier (e.g., Universal Product Code (UPC), Quick Response (QR) Code, or any other codes used to identify an item or product for sale). In another example, the unsupervised data sampling logic or machine learning algorithm may select an appropriate number of clusters automatically by deciding when to partition a cluster further and when it has achieved enough splits as illustrated in several embodiments herein. Moreover, disclosures described herein may leverage domain knowledge/data like bin location of images along heterogenous data signals like OCR, image feature vector, bbox shape, coordinates, and/or other known image processing techniques for detection and/or classification of objects/items in an image to perform unsupervised data sampling.

(83) Further, the circuits, circuitry, systems, devices, processes, methods, techniques, functionality, services, servers, sources and the like described herein may be utilized, implemented and/or run on many different types of devices and/or systems. FIG. **10** illustrates an exemplary system **1000** that may be used for implementing any of the components, circuits, circuitry, systems, functionality, apparatuses, processes, or devices of the system **100** of FIG. **1**, the movable image capture device **120** of FIG. **2**, the computing device **150** of FIG. **3**, the system **400** of FIG. **4**, the system **500** of FIG. **5**, the method **600** of FIG. **6**, the system **700** of FIG. **7**, the method **800** of FIG. **8**, the method **900** of FIG. **9**, and/or other above or below mentioned systems or devices, or parts of such circuits, circuitry, functionality, systems, apparatuses, processes, or devices. For example, the system **1000** may be used to implement some or all of the system for processing captured images of objects at a product storage facility, the user interface **350**, the computing device **150**, the control circuit **310**, the memory storage/s **402**, the database **140**, the network **130**, the image capture device/s **120** and the motorized robotic unit **406**, and/or other such components, circuitry, functionality and/or devices. However, the use of the system **1000** or any portion thereof is certainly not required.

(84) By way of example, the system **1000** may comprise a processor module (or a control circuit) **1012**, memory **1014**, and one or more communication links, paths, buses or the like **1018**. Some embodiments may include one or more user interfaces **1016**, and/or one or more internal and/or external power sources or supplies **1040**. The control circuit **1012** can be implemented through one or more processors, microprocessors, central processing unit, logic, local digital storage, firmware, software, and/or other control hardware and/or software, and may be used to execute or assist in executing the steps of the processes, methods, functionality and techniques described herein, and control various communications, decisions, programs, content, listings, services, interfaces, logging, reporting, etc. Further, in some embodiments, the control circuit **1012** can be part of control circuitry and/or a control system **1010**, which may be implemented through one or more processors with access to one or more memory **1014** that can store instructions, code and the like

that is implemented by the control circuit and/or processors to implement intended functionality. In some applications, the control circuit and/or memory may be distributed over a communications network (e.g., LAN, WAN, Internet) providing distributed and/or redundant processing and functionality. Again, the system **1000** may be used to implement one or more of the above or below, or parts of, components, circuits, systems, processes and the like. For example, the system **1000** may implement the system for processing captured images of objects at a product storage facility with the control circuit **310** being the control circuit **1012**.

(85) The user interface **1016** can allow a user to interact with the system **1000** and receive information through the system. In some instances, the user interface **1016** includes a display **1022** and/or one or more user inputs **1024**, such as buttons, touch screen, track ball, keyboard, mouse, etc., which can be part of or wired or wirelessly coupled with the system **1000**. Typically, the system **1000** further includes one or more communication interfaces, ports, transceivers **1020** and the like allowing the system **1000** to communicate over a communication bus, a distributed computer and/or communication network (e.g., a local area network (LAN), the Internet, wide area network (WAN), etc.), communication link **1018**, other networks or communication channels with other devices and/or other such communications or combination of two or more of such communication methods. Further the transceiver **1020** can be configured for wired, wireless, optical, fiber optical cable, satellite, or other such communication configurations or combinations of two or more of such communications. Some embodiments include one or more input/output (I/O) interface **1034** that allow one or more devices to couple with the system **1000**. The I/O interface can be substantially any relevant port or combinations of ports, such as but not limited to USB, Ethernet, or other such ports. The I/O interface **1034** can be configured to allow wired and/or wireless communication coupling to external components. For example, the I/O interface can provide wired communication and/or wireless communication (e.g., Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, cellular, RF, and/or other such wireless communication), and in some instances may include any known wired and/or wireless interfacing device, circuit and/or connecting device, such as but not limited to one or more transmitters, receivers, transceivers, or combination of two or more of such devices.

(86) In some embodiments, the system may include one or more sensors **1026** to provide information to the system and/or sensor information that is communicated to another component, such as the user interface **350**, the computing device **150**, the control circuit **310**, the memory storage/s **402**, the database **140**, the network **130**, the image capture device/s **120** and the motorized robotic unit **406**, etc. The sensors can include substantially any relevant sensor, such as temperature sensors, distance measurement sensors (e.g., optical units, sound/ultrasound units, etc.), optical based scanning sensors to sense and read optical patterns (e.g., bar codes), radio frequency identification (RFID) tag reader sensors capable of reading RFID tags in proximity to the sensor, and other such sensors. The foregoing examples are intended to be illustrative and are not intended to convey an exhaustive listing of all possible sensors. Instead, it will be understood that these teachings will accommodate sensing any of a wide variety of circumstances in a given application setting.

(87) The system **1000** comprises an example of a control and/or processor-based system with the control circuit **1012**. Again, the control circuit **1012** can be implemented through one or more processors, controllers, central processing units, logic, software and the like. Further, in some implementations the control circuit **1012** may provide multiprocessor functionality.

(88) The memory **1014**, which can be accessed by the control circuit **1012**, typically includes one or more processor readable and/or computer readable media accessed by at least the control circuit **1012**, and can include volatile and/or nonvolatile media, such as RAM, ROM, EEPROM, flash memory and/or other memory technology. Further, the memory **1014** is shown as internal to the control system **1010**; however, the memory **1014** can be internal, external or a combination of internal and external memory. Similarly, some or all of the memory **1014** can be internal, external or a combination of internal and external memory of the control circuit **1012**. The external memory

can be substantially any relevant memory such as, but not limited to, solid-state storage devices or drives, hard drive, one or more of universal serial bus (USB) stick or drive, flash memory secure digital (SD) card, other memory cards, and other such memory or combinations of two or more of such memory, and some or all of the memory may be distributed at multiple locations over the computer network. The memory **1014** can store code, software, executables, scripts, data, content, lists, programming, programs, log or history data, user information, customer information, product information, and the like. While FIG. **10** illustrates the various components being coupled together via a bus, it is understood that the various components may actually be coupled to the control circuit and/or one or more other components directly.

(89) Those skilled in the art will recognize that a wide variety of other modifications, alterations, and combinations can also be made with respect to the above described embodiments without departing from the scope of the invention, and that such modifications, alterations, and combinations are to be viewed as being within the ambit of the inventive concept.

(90) This application is related to the following applications, each of which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety: entitled SYSTEMS AND METHODS OF SELECTING AN IMAGE FROM A GROUP OF IMAGES OF A RETAIL PRODUCT STORAGE AREA filed on Oct. 11, 2022, application Ser. No. 17/963,787; entitled SYSTEMS AND METHODS OF IDENTIFYING INDIVIDUAL RETAIL PRODUCTS IN A PRODUCT STORAGE AREA BASED ON AN IMAGE OF THE PRODUCT STORAGE AREA filed on Oct. 11, 2022, application Ser. No. 17/963,802; entitled CLUSTERING OF ITEMS WITH HETEROGENEOUS DATA POINTS filed on Oct. 11, 2022, application Ser. No. 17/963,903; entitled SYSTEMS AND METHODS OF TRANSFORMING IMAGE DATA TO PRODUCT STORAGE FACILITY LOCATION INFORMATION filed on Oct. 11, 2022, application Ser. No. 17/963,751; entitled SYSTEMS AND METHODS OF MAPPING AN INTERIOR SPACE OF A PRODUCT STORAGE FACILITY filed on Oct. 14, 2022, application Ser. No. 17/966,580; entitled SYSTEMS AND METHODS OF DETECTING PRICE TAGS AND ASSOCIATING THE PRICE TAGS WITH PRODUCTS filed on Oct. 21, 2022, application Ser. No. 17/971,350; entitled SYSTEMS AND METHODS OF VERIFYING PRICE TAG LABEL-PRODUCT PAIRINGS filed on Nov. 9, 2022, application Ser. No. 17/983,773; entitled SYSTEMS AND METHODS OF USING CACHED IMAGES TO DETERMINE PRODUCT COUNTS ON PRODUCT STORAGE STRUCTURES OF A PRODUCT STORAGE FACILITY filed Jan. 24, 2023, application Ser. No. 18/158,969; entitled METHODS AND SYSTEMS FOR CREATING REFERENCE IMAGE TEMPLATES FOR IDENTIFICATION OF PRODUCTS ON PRODUCT STORAGE STRUCTURES OF A RETAIL FACILITY filed Jan. 24, 2023, application Ser. No. 18/158,983; entitled SYSTEMS AND METHODS FOR PROCESSING IMAGES CAPTURED AT A PRODUCT STORAGE FACILITY filed Jan. 24, 2023, application Ser. No. 18/158,925; and entitled SYSTEMS AND METHODS FOR PROCESSING IMAGES CAPTURED AT A PRODUCT STORAGE FACILITY filed Jan. 24, 2023, application Ser. No. 18/158,950; entitled SYSTEMS AND METHODS OF UPDATING MODEL TEMPLATES ASSOCIATED WITH IMAGES OF RETAIL PRODUCTS AT PRODUCT STORAGE FACILITIES filed Jan. 30, 2023, application Ser. No. 18/102,999; and entitled SYSTEMS AND METHODS FOR DETECTING SUPPORT MEMBERS OF PRODUCT STORAGE STRUCTURES AT PRODUCT STORAGE FACILITIES, filed Jan. 30, 2023, application Ser. No. 18/103,338.

Claims

1. A system for processing captured images of objects at a product storage facility, the system comprising: a memory configured to store a plurality of images, the plurality of images comprising first images and second images, wherein each of the first images contain items not detected by a trained machine learning model as being associated with a recognized product identifier, and

wherein each of the second images contain items detected by the trained machine learning model as being associated with multiple recognized product identifiers; and a control circuit executing the trained machine learning model configured to: allocate each of the first images into one of a plurality of datasets based on areas in the product storage facility the first images were captured; for each dataset of the plurality of datasets, cluster each image in the dataset into one of a plurality of groups based on a degree of resemblance of items depicted in the image relative to those items depicted in other images in the dataset; select a sample from at least one of the plurality of groups; cluster each of the second images into one of a dominant product identifier group and a non-dominant product identifier group; select a sample from the dominant product identifier group; select a sample from the non-dominant product identifier group; and output at least one of the selected sample from the at least one of the plurality of groups, the selected sample from the dominant product identifier group, and the selected sample from the non-dominant product identifier group to be used to retrain the trained machine learning model.

2. The system of claim 1, wherein the plurality of groups comprise a homogenous group, a heterogeneous group, a low similarity group, and an individual group.

3. The system of claim 2, wherein the homogenous group includes images where the degree of resemblance of items depicted in each image is greater than 70%.

4. The system of claim 2, wherein the heterogeneous group includes images where the degree of resemblance of items depicted in each image is at least 30% but no more than 70%.

5. The system of claim 2, wherein the low similarity group includes images where the degree of resemblance of items depicted in each image is less than 30%.

6. The system of claim 2, wherein the individual group includes images that do not have resemblance with any other image in the dataset.

7. The system of claim 2, wherein the control circuit executing the trained machine learning model is further configured to: process each image included in the low similarity group by determining the degree of resemblance of items depicted in the image, and clustering the image into one of the homogenous group, the heterogeneous group, the low similarity group, or the individual group in accordance with the determined degree of resemblance of the items; and repeat processing of subsequent images included in the low similarity group until each of the subsequent images is clustered into one of the homogenous group, the heterogeneous group, or the individual group in accordance with the determined degree of resemblance of the items.

8. The system of claim 1, wherein the control circuit executing the trained machine learning model is further configured to determine the degree of resemblance of items based on at least one of a textual similarity or a visual similarity of the items.

9. The system of claim 1, wherein the selected sample from the at least one of the plurality of groups comprises a sample of one or more images based on a rule from each of the plurality of groups.

10. The system of claim 9, wherein the control circuit executing the trained machine learning model is further configured to group the sample of the one or more images from each of the plurality of groups into the selected sample, wherein the selected sample is output in response to a determination that an image count of the selected sample is less than a threshold.

11. The system of claim 10, wherein the control circuit executing the trained machine learning model is further configured to: in response to a determination that the image count of the selected sample is at least the threshold, allocate each image in the selected sample into one of the plurality of datasets based on the areas in the product storage facility images in the selected sample were captured; for each dataset of the plurality of datasets, cluster each image in the dataset into one of the plurality of groups based on the degree of resemblance of items depicted in the image relative to those items depicted in other images in the dataset; select a second sample from at least one of the plurality of groups; and determine whether a second image count of the second sample is less than the threshold, wherein the allocation of each image in the selected sample into one of the

plurality of datasets, the clustering of each image in the dataset into one of the plurality of groups, and the selection of a subsequent sample from at least one of the plurality of groups are repeated until the subsequent sample is less than the threshold.

12. The system of claim 9, wherein the plurality of groups comprise a homogenous group, a heterogeneous group, a low similarity group, and an individual group, and wherein the rule comprises: selecting, by the control circuit executing the trained machine learning model and for images included in the homogenous group, at least two or three images based on a highest number of at least one of depicted bounding boxes, boundary box aspect ratio, or Optical Character Recognition (OCR) count; selecting, by the control circuit executing the trained machine learning model and for images included in the heterogeneous group, a predetermined percentage of the images included in the heterogeneous group; and selecting, by the control circuit executing the trained machine learning model and for images included in the individual group, all images included in the individual group.

13. The system of claim 1, wherein the selected sample from the dominant product identifier group comprises an image having a threshold range of depicted items being associated with a dominant product identifier, wherein the dominant product identifier is a product identifier that is most identified with the depicted items relative to other identified product identifiers of the depicted items in the image.

14. The system of claim 1, wherein the selected sample from the non-dominant product identifier group comprises all images associated with the non-dominant product identifier group.

15. The system of claim 1, wherein the areas comprise one of an aisle, a bin, a pallet, or a rack storing one or more office supply products, grocery products, electronic products, and household supply products.

16. A method for processing captured images of objects at a product storage facility, the method comprising: storing, by a memory, a plurality of images, the plurality of images comprising first images and second images, wherein each of the first images contain items not detected by a trained machine learning model as being associated with a recognized product identifier, and wherein each of the second images contain items detected by the trained machine learning model as being associated with multiple recognized product identifiers; allocating, by a control circuit executing the trained machine learning model, each of the first images into one of a plurality of datasets based on areas in the product storage facility the first images were captured; for each dataset of the plurality of datasets, clustering, by the control circuit executing the trained machine learning model, each image in the dataset into one of a plurality of groups based on a degree of resemblance of items depicted in the image relative to those items depicted in other images in the dataset; selecting, by the control circuit executing the trained machine learning model, a sample from at least one of the plurality of groups; clustering, by the control circuit executing the trained machine learning model, each of the second images into one of a dominant product identifier group and a non-dominant product identifier group; selecting, by the control circuit executing the trained machine learning model, a sample from the dominant product identifier group; selecting, by the control circuit executing the trained machine learning model, a sample from the non-dominant product identifier group; and outputting, by the control circuit executing the trained machine learning model, at least one of the selected sample from the at least one of the plurality of groups, the selected sample from the dominant product identifier group, and the selected sample from the non-dominant product identifier group to be used to retrain the trained machine learning model.

17. The method of claim 16, wherein the plurality of groups comprise a homogenous group, a heterogeneous group, a low similarity group, and an individual group, wherein the homogenous group includes images where the degree of resemblance of items depicted in each image is greater than 70%, wherein the low similarity group includes images where the degree of resemblance of items depicted in each image is less than 30%, wherein the heterogeneous group includes images where the degree of resemblance of items depicted in each image is at least 30% but no more than

70%, and wherein the individual group includes images that do not have resemblance with any other image in the dataset.

18. The method of claim 16, further comprising determining, by the control circuit executing the trained machine learning model, the degree of resemblance of items based on at least one of a textual similarity or a visual similarity of the items.

19. The method of claim 16, wherein the selected sample from the at least one of the plurality of groups comprises a sample of one or more images based on a rule from each of the plurality of groups.

20. The method of claim 19, further comprising grouping, by the control circuit executing the trained machine learning model, the sample of the one or more images from each of the plurality of groups into the selected sample, wherein the selected sample is output in response to a determination that an image count of the selected sample is less than a threshold.
